

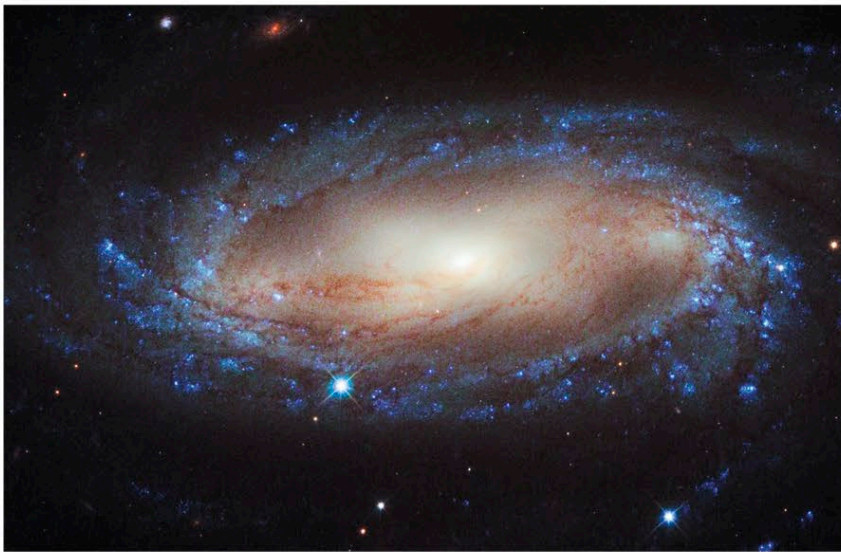
ANTLIA

THE AIR PUMP

THIS FAINT CONSTELLATION CONTAINS AN INTERESTING CLUSTER OF GALAXIES, BUT ANTLIA IS UNREWARDING FOR THOSE WHO ARE OBSERVING IT WITHOUT USING A LARGE TELESCOPE.

Antlia was introduced by the French astronomer Nicholas Louis de Lacaille. He formed it out of stars seen from his observatory close to Table Mountain, South Africa. On returning to France, he published a star catalog and a southern-sky map that included Antlia as well as 13 other newly devised constellations. Named Antlia Pneumatica on his map, the constellation represents a vacuum pump.

This inconspicuous grouping of stars has no named stars, bright clusters, or nebulae but includes the Antlia Cluster, the third-nearest cluster of galaxies to us. The two 6th-magnitude stars that are designated Zeta form an optical double and can be seen separately through binoculars.



△ **IC 2560**
The extremely bright nucleus of spiral galaxy IC 2560 can be seen in this Hubble Space Telescope image. It is caused by the ejection of huge amounts of super-hot gas from the region around the galaxy's central black hole. IC 2560 is a member of the Antlia Cluster, a cluster of about 250 galaxies.

KEY DATA	
Size ranking	62
Brightest stars	Alpha (α) 4.3, Epsilon (ε) 4.5
Genitive	Antliae
Abbreviation	Ant
Highest in sky at 10pm	March–April
Fully visible	49°N–90°S



CHART 5

MAIN STARS	
Alpha (α) Antliae	Orange giant
☼ 4.3	↔ 366 light-years
Epsilon (ε) Antliae	Orange giant
☼ 4.5	↔ 700 light-years
Iota (ι) Antliae	Orange giant
☼ 4.6	↔ 199 light-years
Theta (θ) Antliae	Binary star; a white main-sequence and a yellow giant
☼ 4.8	↔ 384 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS	
NGC 2997	Spiral galaxy
IC 2560	Spiral galaxy, also classed as a Seyfert

